

CASE ID: 200211710712

EPISODE NAME: Dalai Lama Visits Mongolia 2002

2002/11/05 - 2002/11/07

Sender: China (710)

Target: Mongolia (712)

Issue: Terminate Support of Non-State Actors (10)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Narrative:

On 2002/11/05, the Chinese government blocked railway crossings to Mongolia in retaliation for allowing the Dalai Lama to visit Gandantegchinlen Monastery, Mongolia's largest Buddhist monastery, in Ulaanbaatar.¹²

The most recent visit to Mongolia by the exiled Tibetan occurred seven years prior in 1995.³ The Chinese government considers the Dalai Lama a threat to its control over Tibet.⁴ The religious leader has been in exile since his escape to India in 1959.⁵

China responded to the visit by blocking a railway crossing between the two countries for two days without warning, beginning on 2002/11/05. Although China claimed the stoppage was due to unspecified technical issues, an executive in the Chinese copper industry reportedly stated that the Chinese government ordered a temporary ban on Mongolian imports because of the Dalai Lama's visit to Mongolia.⁶ Due to the importance of the Mongolian copper industry, the ban produced a temporary 1.3 percent increase in three-month prices on the London Metal Exchange.⁷

Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesman Kong Quan urged Mongolia to reconsider allowing the Dalai Lama to visit the country in the future.⁸ On 2002/11/07, the border crossing was reopened, and rail traffic resumed normally.⁹ The Dalai Lama continued his visits to Mongolia in the years following the incident.¹⁰

¹ Ang, Audra. "Dalai Lama Visits Mongolia for First Time in Seven Years." *The Star Banner*, November 5th, 2002. www.ocala.com/story/news/2002/11/05/dalai-lama-visits-mongolia-for-first-time-in-seven-years/31265793007/.

² McDonald, Joe. "China Restores Mongolia Rail Service." *The Edwardsville Intelligencer*, November 6th, 2002. www.theintelligencer.com/news/article/China-Restores-Mongolia-Rail-Service-10536785.php.

³ Ang, Audra. "Dalai Lama Visits Mongolia for First Time in Seven Years." *The Star Banner*, November 5th, 2002. www.ocala.com/story/news/2002/11/05/dalai-lama-visits-mongolia-for-first-time-in-seven-years/31265793007/.

⁴ Ibid.

⁵ Ibid.

⁶ McDonald, Joe. "China Restores Mongolia Rail Service." *The Edwardsville Intelligencer*, November 6th, 2002. www.theintelligencer.com/news/article/China-Restores-Mongolia-Rail-Service-10536785.php.

⁷ Ibid.

⁸ Ibid.

⁹ McDonald, Joe. "China Restores Mongolia Rail Service." *The Edwardsville Intelligencer*, November 6th, 2002. www.theintelligencer.com/news/article/China-Restores-Mongolia-Rail-Service-10536785.php.

¹⁰ "Chronology-Six Rounds of China, Dalai Lama Envoy Talks." *Reuters*, May 5th, 2008. www.reuters.com/article/world/chronology-six-rounds-of-china-dalai-lama-envoy-talks-idUSSP137369.